



The New Food Guide

Health Canada
Office of Nutrition Policy and Promotion
2019



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 - For health professionals and policy makers
 - For Canadians
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Background



Why the Food Guide Matters to Canadians

- Integrated widely by governments and stakeholders into nutrition policies, programs, and resources.
- Taught in schools and promoted by health professionals when supporting Canadians to eat well.
- Can help influence the foods served and sold in Canada's public institutions from day cares and schools, to long-term care facilities, as well as the foods Canadians choose for themselves and their families.



Why Revise?

- To **address challenges** for users such as:
 - Applying recommendations in every day life, including building healthy meals and snacks.
 - Providing the right information to the right audience.
- To **ensure alignment** with most current evidence on topics such as sodium, saturated fat and sugars.



Evidence and Engagement



Solid Evidence

The best available evidence was considered, including:

- Only high-quality scientific reports on food and health from respected authorities including systematic reviews on over **100** food-related topics.
- Over **400** convincing conclusions.

The *Evidence Review for Dietary Guidance 2015* and the *Food, Nutrients and Health: Interim Evidence Update 2018*, form the foundation of the new Food Guide.

Industry-commissioned reports were excluded to reduce the potential for, or the perception of, conflict of interest.



Responsible and Meaningful Engagement

- Consulted extensively to ensure resources are evidence based, useful, and relevant to Canadians.
- Online public consultations with Canadians and interested stakeholders helped to identify needs and expectations.
- To help communicate the guidance accurately, targeted consultations were held with:
 - Academics
 - Indigenous experts
 - Provincial and territorial governments
 - Other federal departments
 - National Indigenous Organizations
 - Health professional regulatory bodies/organizations and health charities



Openness and Transparency

- Submissions received during public consultations were summarized in *What We Heard* reports available at [Canada.ca](https://www.canada.ca).
- When Health Canada senior officials met with organizations to discuss the development of the Food Guide, details including the name of the organization and purpose of meeting, were posted on [Canada.ca](https://www.canada.ca).
- Health Canada's Office of Nutrition Policy and Promotion officials responsible for drafting the Food Guide did not meet with industry representatives to discuss the Food Guide.



Relevant and Useful



User-Centred

Public opinion research and consultations to understand how healthy eating information is used.



Health Literacy

Lens applied throughout the crafting and testing of messages.



Diversity

Tested with a range of ages, household incomes, locations, education levels, and cultural backgrounds.



Considerations

Determinants of health, the environment, and cultural diversity, including social, cultural and historical context of Indigenous Peoples.



What's New with Canada's Food Guide?



Canada's Food Guide at a Glance

The new Food Guide is an **online suite of resources** that better meets the needs of different users including the general public, policy makers, and health professionals, including:

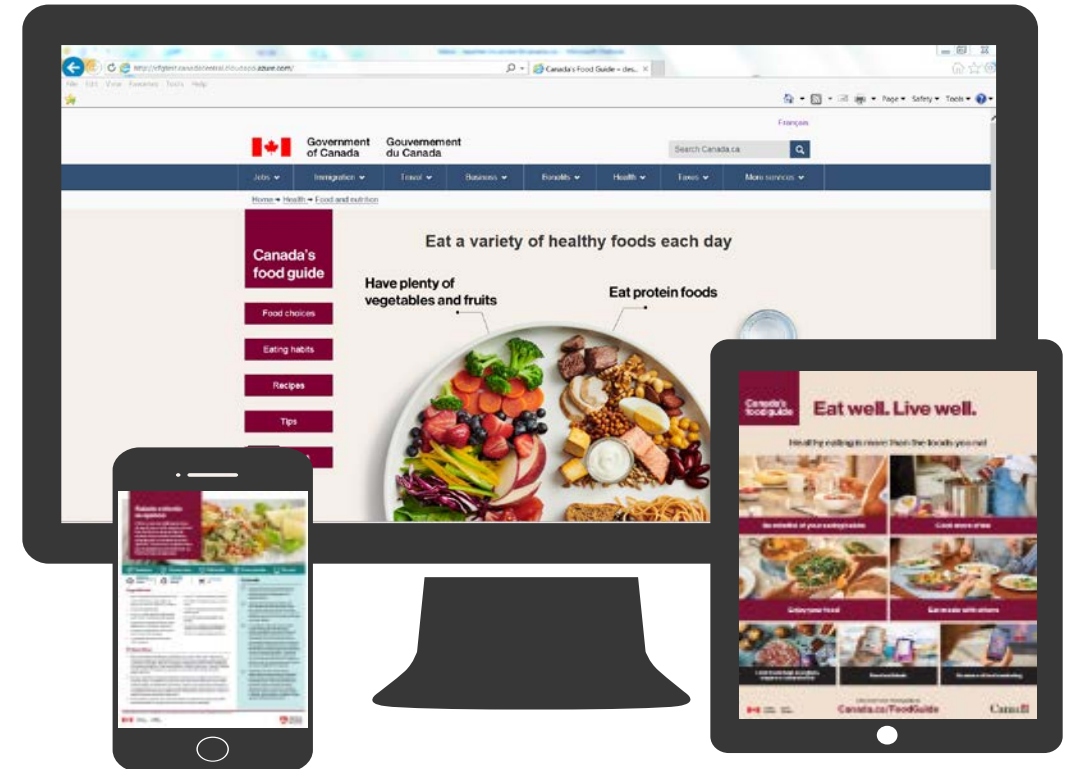
- Actionable advice for Canadians on healthy food choices and healthy eating habits including cooking more often and being mindful of eating habits.
- Updated recommendations on saturated fat, sodium, and sugars including guidance on confectioneries and sugary drinks such as soft drinks, sweetened milk and juice.
- Mobile-responsive web content to support Canadians in eating healthily whenever, and wherever they go.



Online Resources

Available in English and French

- Canada's Dietary Guidelines for Health Professionals and Policy Makers
- Food Guide snapshot
- Videos, recipes and actionable advice
- Evidence including the *Evidence Review for Dietary Guidance 2015* and the *Food, Nutrients and Health: Interim Evidence Update 2018*

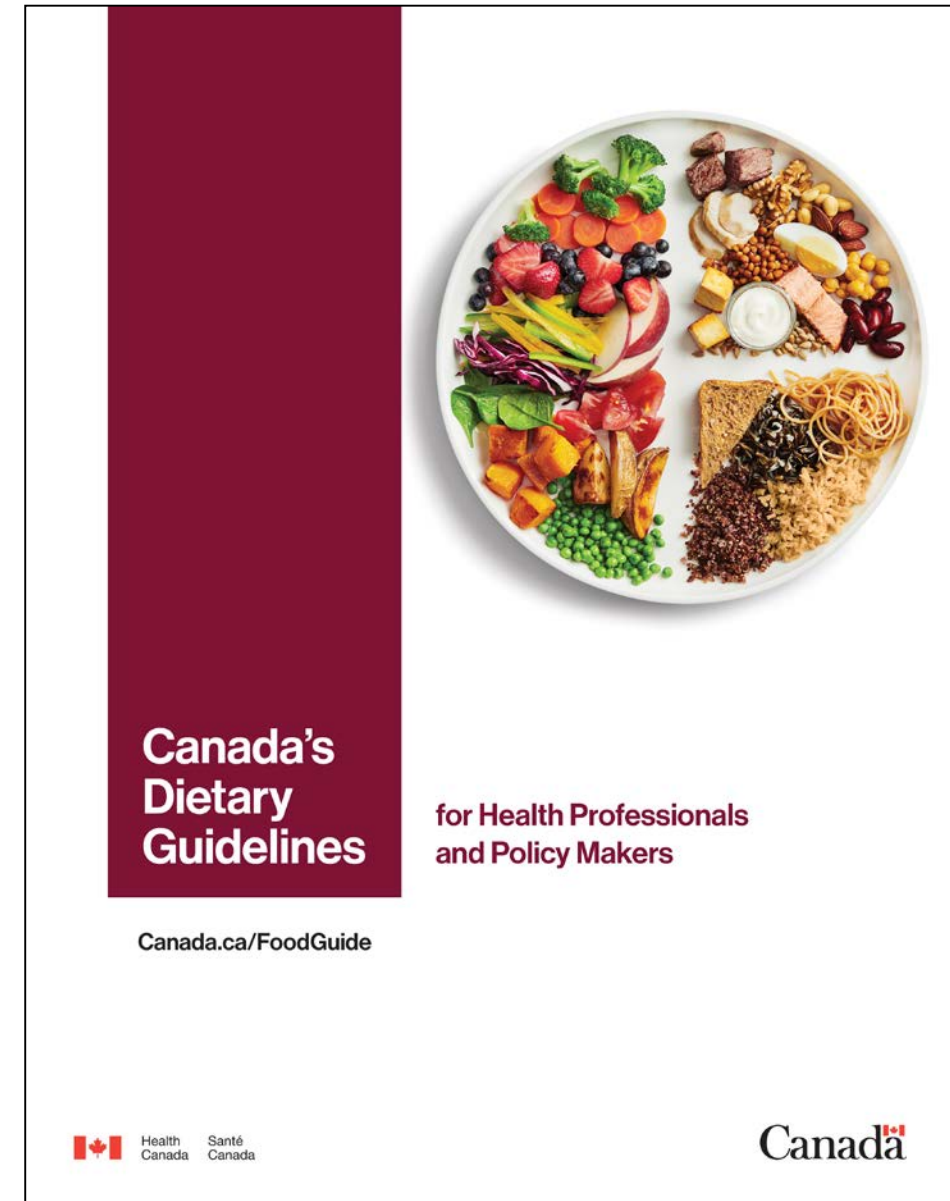


Canada.ca/FoodGuide

Canada's Dietary Guidelines

For Health Professionals and Policy Makers

- For use when developing policies, programs, and educational resources.
- Forms the foundation for the Food Guide resources.
- Provides guidance on:
 - Nutritious foods and beverages that are the foundation for healthy eating.
 - Foods and beverages that can have a negative impact on health when consumed on a regular basis.
 - Food skills as a practical way to support healthy eating.
 - Supportive environments for healthy eating.



Guideline 1: Foundation for Healthy Eating

Vegetables, fruit, whole grains, and protein foods should be consumed regularly. Among protein foods, consume plant-based more often.

Why? Patterns of eating that emphasize plant-based foods typically result in higher intakes of vegetables and fruit, nuts, soy protein, and fibre; and lower intake of processed meats and foods that contain mostly saturated fat.

- ✓ Eating more vegetables and fruit is linked to a lower risk of cardiovascular disease.
- ✓ Eating more nuts or soy protein is linked to improved blood lipid levels.
- ✓ Higher fibre intake is linked to improved blood lipid levels and a lower risk of cardiovascular disease, colon cancer, and type 2 diabetes.
- ✓ Processed meat has been linked to colorectal cancer and foods that contain mostly saturated fat are linked to unfavourable blood lipid levels and a higher risk of type 2 diabetes.

Protein foods include legumes, nuts, seeds, tofu, fortified soy beverage, fish, shellfish, eggs, poultry, lean red meat including wild game, lower fat milk, lower fat yogurts, lower fat kefir, and cheeses lower in fat and sodium.

Guideline 1: Foundation for Healthy Eating

Foods that contain mostly unsaturated fat should replace foods that contain mostly saturated fat.

Why? Cardiovascular disease is one of the leading causes of death in Canada.

- ✓ Lowering the intake of saturated fat by replacing it with unsaturated fat decreases total and LDL-cholesterol.
- ✓ Elevated LDL-cholesterol is a well-established risk factor for cardiovascular disease.



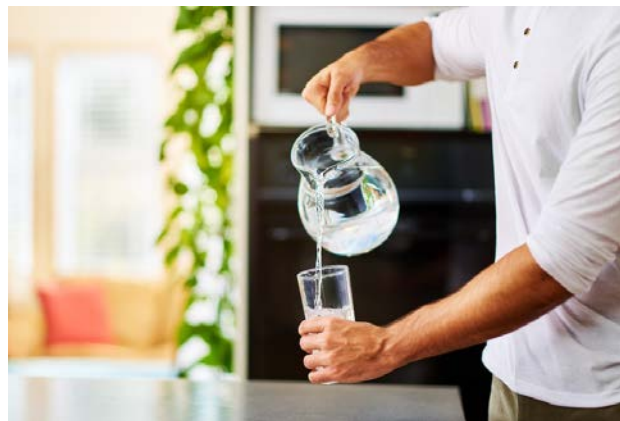
The intention is not to reduce total fat in the diet. Rather, it is to help reduce intakes of saturated fat, while encouraging foods that contain mostly unsaturated fat.

Guideline 1: Foundation for Healthy Eating

Water should be the beverage of choice.

Why? Water supports health and promotes hydration without adding calories to the diet.

- ✓ Water is essential for metabolic and digestive processes.
- ✓ Adequate intake is based on the total water required to prevent the effects of dehydration.



Guideline 2: Foods and Beverages that Undermine Healthy Eating

Processed or prepared foods and beverages that contribute to excess sodium, free sugars, or saturated fat undermine healthy eating and should not be consumed regularly.

Why? Canadians are purchasing more highly processed foods.

- ✓ When consumed on a regular basis, they can contribute to excess sodium, sugars, or saturated fat. These nutrients are linked to chronic disease risk when consumed in excess.



Guideline 2: Foods and Beverages that Undermine Healthy Eating - *Considerations*

There are health risks associated with alcohol consumption.

Why? Alcoholic beverages can contribute a lot of calories to the diet with little to no nutritive value. They also increase the risk of developing chronic disease.

- ✓ Alcohol can be a significant source of sodium, free sugars, or saturated fat when mixed with syrups, sugary drinks, or cream-based liquors.
- ✓ Well-established health risks are associated with long-term alcohol consumption, including increased risk of many types of cancer and other serious health conditions, such as hypertension and liver disease.

Foods and beverages offered in publically funded institutions should align with Canada's Dietary Guidelines.

Why? Offering healthier options and limiting the availability of highly processed foods and beverages, such as sugary drinks and confectioneries, creates supportive environments for healthy eating.

Guideline 3: Importance of Food Skills

Cooking and food preparation using nutritious foods should be promoted as a practical way to support healthy eating.

Why? There has been a shift from cooking meals with basic ingredients towards use of highly processed products.

- ✓ The increased use of these products has decreased the transfer of food skills to children and adolescents.
- ✓ Improving food skills by cooking and preparing food at home can contribute to improved food choices and eating behaviours among Canadians of all ages. It may also make it easier for Canadians to reduce household food waste.



Guideline 3: Importance of Food Skills

Food labels should be promoted as a tool to help Canadians make informed food choices.

Why? Food labels can help Canadians make informed food choices in various settings, such as grocery stores.

- ✓ Encouraging the use of food labels can be an effective strategy to promote the selection of nutritious foods and support the preparation of healthy meals and snacks.



Food Guide Snapshot

For Canadians

- At-a-glance presentation of food choices and eating habits.
- Available in mobile-friendly and PDF format.
- Online entry point to Canada's healthy eating recommendations (*slides 26-28*).



Food Guide Snapshot

- Provides a clear and simplified way to communicate the key concepts of Canada's Dietary Guidelines and Healthy Eating Recommendations for Canadians.
- Depicts the concept of proportionality with respect to food groupings to support Canadians in building healthy meals.
- Shows food examples to represent a variety of nutritious foods.



Food Guide Snapshot

- The following considerations were taken into account when choosing foods on the Food Guide plate:
 - Alignment with Canada's Dietary Guidelines
 - Reflective of a range of cultures
 - Relevance to Indigenous peoples in Canada
 - Commonly produced in Canada
- Important to note that many of the food options depicted on the plate are available as frozen, dried, or canned and can be healthy options.



Implementation of Dietary Guidelines

Programs and policies that align with these Guidelines provide an opportunity to create supportive environments for healthy eating.

Creating supportive environments across settings, such as schools, workplaces, recreation centres, and health care facilities, can help increase the influence of the Guidelines.

Understanding and acting on the barriers that make it challenging for Canadians to make healthy food choices are essential for the successful implementation of the Guidelines.

Eat a Variety of Healthy Foods Each Day

Eat plenty of vegetables and fruits, whole grain foods and protein foods. Choose protein foods that come from plants more often.

- Choose foods with healthy fats instead of saturated fat.

Examples:

- Vegetables and fruit including fresh, frozen or canned options.
- Whole grain foods such as whole grain pasta, brown rice and quinoa.
- Protein foods such as lentils, lean meats, fish, unsweetened milk and fortified soy beverages.
- Foods with healthy fats, such as nuts, seeds, avocados, fatty fish, vegetable oils, and soft margarine.



Eat a Variety of Healthy Foods Each Day



Make water your drink of choice.

- Replace sugary drinks with water.

Unsweetened healthy drink options other than water can include lower fat white milk, plant-based beverages, coffee and tea.



Eat a Variety of Healthy Foods Each Day

- **Limit highly processed foods.** If you choose these foods, eat them less often and in small amounts.
 - Prepare meals and snacks using ingredients that have little to no added sodium, sugars or saturated fat.
 - Choose healthier menu options when eating out.
- **Use food labels.**
- **Be aware that food marketing can influence your choices.**



Healthy Eating is More Than the Foods You Eat

Be Mindful of Your Eating Habits.

- Take time to eat. Notice when you are hungry and when you are full.

Enjoy Your Food.

- Culture and food traditions can be part of healthy eating.

Cook More Often.

- Involve others in planning and preparing meals.

Eat Meals with Others.

- Share food traditions, across generations and cultures.



Communicating the New Food Guide

- Health Canada is promoting healthy habits such as family meals, developing food skills, and how to shape the eating habits of children.
- The new Food Guide messages have shifted away from quantity messages (food guide servings sizes and numbers of servings from food groups) to focus the advice on the quality of food choices.

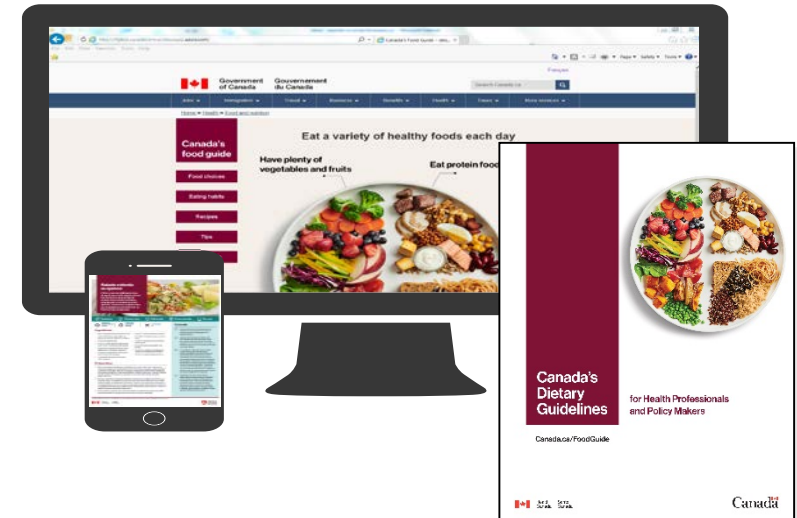
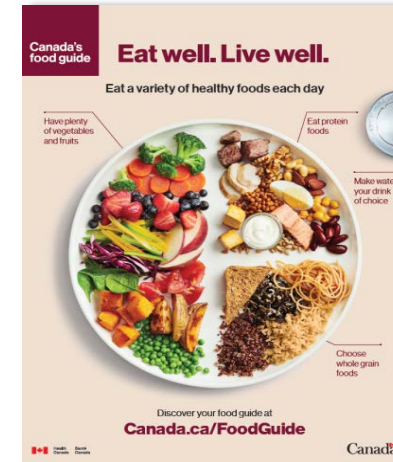
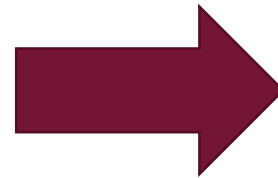


Canada's food guide

Beyond the Plate

Food Guide Snapshot

Canada's Food Guide



Life Stage Guidance



Additional Health Canada Resources

Prenatal Nutrition Guidelines for Health Professionals

Nutrition for Healthy Term Infants: Recommendations from birth to six months.

Nutrition for Healthy Term Infants: Recommendations from six to 24 months.





Protein foods are good for you

You can eat a variety of protein foods as part of a healthy [eating pattern](#).

Protein foods have important nutrients such as:

- protein
- vitamins
- minerals

Choose protein foods that come from plants more often. Plant-based protein foods can provide more fibre and less saturated fat than other types of protein foods. This can be beneficial for your heart health.

You don't need to eat large amounts of protein foods to meet your nutritional needs. Try to eat protein foods such as:

- eggs
- lean meats and poultry
 - lean cuts of beef, pork and wild game
 - turkey
 - chicken
- nuts and seeds
 - peanuts
 - almonds
 - cashews
 - nut butters
 - sunflower seeds
- fish and shellfish
 - trout
 - shrimp
 - salmon
 - scallops
 - sardines
 - mackerel
- lower fat dairy products
 - milk
 - yogurt
 - lower sodium cheeses
- beans, peas and lentils
 - brown, green or red or other lentils
 - peas such as chickpeas and split peas
 - dried beans such as black beans and kidney beans
- fortified soy beverages, tofu, soybeans and other soy products



3 ways to practice healthy snacking

Keep these behaviours in mind to practice healthy snacking.

1. Choose healthy snack foods

Follow the healthy eating recommendation to make it a habit to choose a [variety of healthy foods](#) for your snacks.

Follow the healthy eating recommendation to limit [highly processed snacks](#).

2. Eat your snacks mindfully

Eat your snacks slowly and without distractions, such as watching TV.

Choose small portions. Serve a small amount for your snack and try not to eat directly from large containers.

Eat snacks when you feel hungry, and not just out of routine or when you feel:

- tired
- bored
- emotional

Too much snacking can lead you to eat more than you need.

3. Think about your snacks ahead of time

Think about healthy snacks when planning your meals and add them to your grocery list. Follow the healthy eating recommendation to help make it easier to [plan ahead](#).

Ideas for healthy snacks

Here are some easy ways to eat healthy snacks when you are at:

- work
- home
- school
- on-the-go



Shopping for 1 or 2

It can be challenging to grocery shop for just 1 or 2 people.

Think about meals and snacks you would like to eat and plan your meals around your ideas.

Make a grocery list to help you remember what foods you need.

Choose affordable healthy options if you are grocery shopping on a budget. Some grocery stores offer discount days for seniors.

Make it easy on yourself. Try shopping:

- online
- with a friend
 - you can split larger quantities of foods
- using a delivery service
- using grocery buses organized by seniors' or community centres

Cooking for 1 or 2

You may find it hard to cook healthy meals for 1 or 2 people, especially if you:

- used to cook for a larger family
- have never been the main cook

Prepare meals and snacks when you have the most energy. Find recipes that only use a few ingredients and require little to no cooking. Use these recipes on days when you are too tired to cook.

Cook once, eat twice. Make meals that are great as leftovers or make a larger amount and freeze the extras.

Alternate a cooking day with a friend. This allows you to share the task of making meals and gives you the chance to try each other's recipes and food traditions.

Eating with others

Eating with others is great for the company and it can also be good for your health. It may encourage you to eat more of the foods that you need to stay healthy.

Eat with others as much as you can. Try:

- joining a lunch group
- eating with a neighbour
- inviting a family member over
- planning a potluck with friends

Check local seniors' community centres and ask about monthly lunches or community kitchens you could join.

If you live alone, sitting down to eat a meal by yourself can feel lonely. Try these ideas to keep it enjoyable:

- try a new recipe
- choose a comfortable place to eat
- play music you enjoy during mealtimes



Healthy eating doesn't have to cost more. You can choose many different healthy foods when eating on a budget.

How to eat healthily on a budget

Healthy eating on a budget can be made easier with these ideas:

Stick to your list

Buying only what is on your grocery list will help you cut down on impulse buys.

Shop for sales

Check out flyers, coupons, mobile apps and websites for deals on foods that are on your list.

Look for reduced prices. Products getting close to their best before dates and oddly shaped or slightly bruised produce may be offered at a lower price or discount. These products are just as healthy as "perfect" varieties and buying them also helps reduce [food waste](#).

Compare prices

Compare the unit price on the label to know which product is less expensive.

In grocery stores where price-matching is offered, use flyers to price match products on sale.

Scan different shelves. Companies pay more to place their products at eye level. You may find other versions of the same foods on higher or lower shelves.

Compare prices on generic and brand name products to see if there is a difference before choosing.

Foods sold in single-serve packaging can cost more. Buy the full size or family size version and divide it up yourself.

Stock up

Stock up on canned goods and staples when they are on sale.

Extend the shelf life of sale products. Freeze:

- fish
- fruit
- vegetables
- whole grain bread
- lean meats or poultry

Buying foods in bulk can help you save money. Be careful not to buy more than you need, because this can lead to waste.

Recipes



Slow cooked lasagna

Let your slow cooker do the work and come home to this heartwarming meal.



Fun flatbread pizza

Change up pizza night by using whole grain tortillas. Tortillas bake up nice and crispy, and are sure to become a favourite.



Turkey chili

This must-try chili is so versatile, the possibilities are endless. It can be enjoyed on its own or transformed into other dishes.



West Coast Snapper Burritos

These burritos are a great way to enjoy fish. Everyone will love customizing their burrito with colourful veggies.



Couscous with Vegetables

Here's a fun and colourful recipe! This customizable dish is a tasty and healthy meal that is sure to please.



Eggplant curry

The smell in your kitchen from this aromatic recipe will be enough to have the neighbours running over for dinner.



Moose stew

Complete the field to table experience with this easy to make hearty stew.



Moroccan stew (Harira)

The warm aromatic spices will bring the whole family running into the kitchen for dinner.



Pineapple ginger chicken

This chicken dish is tender and full of flavor.



Next Steps



What's Still to Come

More specific guidance for Health Professionals and Policy Makers

- Will be released later in 2019
- For use by health professionals and policy makers
- Will build on *Canada's Dietary Guidelines*

Online resources

- Will be enhanced on an ongoing basis

Considerations for Indigenous Peoples

- Health Canada and Indigenous Services Canada are working with First Nations, Inuit and Métis to support the development of distinction-based healthy eating tools as part of the revision process.





Thank you!

